

Lemon Tart (Tarte au Citron) (Variation 9)

Tags: *dessert, french, lemon, baking, dinner-party* | Prep: 45 min | Cook: 60 min | Serves: 4

Ingredients

- Pastry: 100 g all-purpose flour, 100 g cold butter cubed, 30 g icing sugar, 1 egg yolk, 2–3 tbsp ice cold water, pinch salt
- Lemon curd filling: 2 large eggs, 4 egg yolks, 200 g caster sugar, 200 ml lemon juice (approx 6 lemons), zest of 3 lemons, 150 ml heavy cream, pinch of salt

Method

1. For pastry: pulse flour, butter, icing sugar, and salt in a food processor until resembling breadcrumbs. Add egg yolk and water; pulse until dough just comes together. Shape into a disc, wrap in plastic, and chill 1 hour.
2. Roll out pastry to 3 mm and line a 23 cm tart tin. Trim, then refrigerate 30 minutes.
3. Preheat oven to 190 °C. Line pastry with baking paper and fill with baking beans. Blind bake 15 minutes. Remove paper and beans. Bake 10 more minutes until golden. Cool.
4. Reduce oven to 150 °C.
5. Whisk eggs, yolks, and sugar. Stir in lemon juice, zest, cream, and salt.
6. Strain through a fine sieve into a jug.
7. Place tart shell on oven rack, partially pull out. Pour filling into shell.
8. Bake for 25–30 minutes until just set with a slight wobble in the centre.
9. Cool to room temperature, then refrigerate for 2 hours. Serve with crème fraîche.

Chef Tips

- Straining the filling removes air bubbles and zest fibres, giving a smooth, flawless surface.
- Pour the filling into the tart shell in the oven to avoid spillage when moving.
- The finished tart should wobble like set jelly — it will firm up completely once chilled.